

Cub Scout Pack 3049 — Fall Kickoff & Popcorn Kickoff

Meeting Minutes · Monday, August 31, 2026 · Cedar Creek Church, Fort Wayne

Presenter	Michael Bechill, Committee Chair & Popcorn Kernel
Attendees	Pack 3049 families: returning families and new Lion and Tiger families
Materials	Slide deck (PDF) and meeting recording posted at Pack3049.com

1. Welcome and how the pack works

Michael opened by acknowledging that a first pack meeting feels overwhelming because there is a lot going on: the pack runs between 75 and 97 Scouts in a typical year. On most weeks Scouts line up by den, hold a short opening ceremony, and then break out to den rooms around the building; once a month the whole pack meets together. This is the pack's second year at Cedar Creek Church, and the pack is grateful for a home that can hold this many Scouts (construction on the building is ongoing). New families were welcomed and encouraged to seek out veteran parents in the room and ask for their honest opinions. The pack's guiding goal is age-appropriate, developmentally appropriate Scout programming: dens are organized by grade, each rank has required adventures for the year, and advancement is recognized at pack meetings.

- **Uniforms.** Class A is the official uniform, worn for pack meetings and ceremonies. Class B is the pack t-shirt, worn for den meetings, outings, and anything where a nice uniform might get trashed.
- **Youth protection.** Scouts are never alone with a single adult; the pack practices two-deep leadership everywhere, including trips and restroom breaks.

2. Communication

- **New website: Pack3049.com**, launched about a week ago. The goal is to put the answer to every question a parent could have in one place. It is new, so please report anything missing or confusing so it can be fixed.
- **BAND app** is the pack's primary communication channel (fewer families are on Facebook each year). Join the "Cub Scouts Pack 3049" group via the QR code or link on the website.
- The pack's Facebook page (Cub Scout Pack 3049) remains active as a secondary channel.

3. Leadership and open positions

Michael has served as Committee Chair for seven years and Ashley Bechill has helped run the pack the entire time. The pack always has families cycling in and aging out, and the leadership slide highlights the positions currently open. Michael's youngest is crossing over in about a year and a half, and the goal for that window is to train successors so no one has to learn everything on the fly the way the current leaders did. Parents who might be interested in any role, or who want to help without committing to a title yet, should talk to Michael.

4. Registration and what Scouting costs

- Registration is on the website; the form automatically emails you a copy. Families can join at any point in the year.
- The **pack registration fee is \$100 per Scout for the whole year**. National and council fees are paid through the council's system, so watch for those emails separately.
- The true cost of a Scout year is roughly **\$376 per Scout** (\$85 national, \$54 council, \$15 Scout Life magazine, and about \$222 of pack programming). Popcorn covers the gap between that and the \$100 fee.
- **If cost is a barrier, talk to Michael privately.** No Scout is turned away over money.

5. Popcorn kickoff: why we sell

Popcorn is the pack's one and only fundraiser. It funds every expense except registration: awards, pinewood derby, camping, the spring pie-in-the-face event, and everything in between. The pack's annual budget is a little over \$25,000; at the 2026 commission rate of 38%, that works out to roughly **\$66,000 in sales to break even**. Pack 3049 has been the number one selling pack in the council for five straight years and sold \$64,939 in 2025. The sale runs from now through the week before Thanksgiving.

6. What each family is asked to do

- **Sell \$525 per Scout.** At today's storefront pace that is about two hours of selling if you start early. A family that would rather not sell can do a **\$300 cash buyout**, or any combination of sales and buyout. Everything is due by **December 1**. A calculator on the website shows where you stand.
- **Starter packs.** Every Scout receives a curated starter pack that totals exactly \$525 at retail. The mix was built from last year's actual sales percentages so it sells the way customers actually buy.
- **Checkout party: Wednesday, September 2, 6:00 to 8:30 PM at Dan Noll's house.** Volunteers are needed to build the packs and to check them out to families. No pressure to take popcorn that night; product can be picked up any time through Thanksgiving.
- **Weekly resupply** will be available in front of the church all season. Only check out what you can sell: the pack is on the hook for unsold product, and the council's return window is limited (October 23). Unsold popcorn can be returned to the pack.
- **Sell now.** Storefront shifts are currently producing roughly \$200 to \$800 per shift. Sales taper as the season goes on, so strike while the iron is hot.

7. Where and how to sell

- **Storefronts.** About 98% of pack sales come from storefronts. Sign up through the pack's shift scheduler (QR code in the deck and on the website): book up to 14 days ahead, two-hour shifts, pick your location.
- **Grabill Country Fair, Thursday through Saturday of fair week, all day.** The pack will have a booth on the main drag directly in front of Grabill Vet Clinic, thanks to Ryan and his family for the spot. No sign-up and no need to bring your own popcorn: show up in Class A with a parent, take a turn, and learn. Families have sold around \$2,000 there in a single fair. It is the best place all season for a nervous new Scout to make a first sale.
- **Square.** Every registered Scout gets a Square login emailed to the address on file. **Every sale and every donation, cash or card, must be logged in Square** so your Scout gets credit and the pack can reconcile.
- **Online.** Orders through the PRPopcorn online store ship directly to the customer anywhere in the country and count toward your Scout's total.

8. Rewards

- **4% back:** each Scout receives 4% of their own sales as an Amazon gift card at the end of the season. The pack chose this over the prize catalog because it is worth more and kids can pick what they actually want.
- **\$1,600 in sales = free summer camp at CCLT.**
- **\$3,000 in sales = PR Popcorn Winner's Circle,** a prize choice from the popcorn company (electronics and similar).
- **Pie in the Face** returns in the spring for top sellers.
- Several parents shared their families' experiences: Scouts who started the season staring at their feet were confidently approaching strangers and handling "no thank you" within a few shifts. Learning to talk to people is the real reward.

9. Training and support

- A suggested Scout script is in the deck; the PRPopcorn training videos are linked from the website.
- Michael's cell number is on the leadership slide and the website. Questions at any hour are welcome.

Action items for families

- Register (or renew) at Pack3049.com and join the BAND group.
- Wednesday, Sept 2, 6:00 to 8:30 PM: pick up your Scout's starter pack at Dan Noll's house, or volunteer to help build and check out packs.
- Watch for your Square login email; log every sale and donation, cash or card.
- Sign up for storefront shifts now while sales are strongest, and bring your Scout to the Grabill Country Fair booth.
- By December 1: \$525 in sales, a \$300 buyout, or a combination.
- Consider an open leadership role; talk to Michael.